

and make more profits, but playing a fundamental role in improving the human condition,” he says.

JOBS AND SKILLS

But an overriding question on top of every stakeholder’s mind is this: Could the increased use of automation and digital tech lead to a decline in the IT workforce and the eventual replacement of humans by machines or algorithms?

The number of jobs in the tech industry might not reduce due to automation or the adoption of technology, says Akhilesh Tuteja, Partner, Global Cyber Security Leader, National Alliances and TMT Industry Leader at KPMG in India. “There is absolutely no doubt in my mind that the number of jobs in the technology industry, even after all of these advancements, will grow substantially.” He drives home the point with an example of how the advent of AI might lead to more jobs with the topical example of ChatGPT. “OpenAI has just had a big breakthrough—ChatGPT. It has been less than a few weeks and the number of platforms built on top of ChatGPT has already proliferated. There are more than 50 use cases being worked out—and this is just the tip of the iceberg,” he says. And with so many platforms, the number of people who are trying to build value via the AI is also significant.

Avaali’s Kannan breaks it down further by saying that rapid automation, digitisation and applications of AI would not make the current workforce redundant but simply “shift the skillset to more relevant skills”.

As we stand on the precipice of this technological transformation, businesses also have a responsibility to do their part in retraining their employees, stresses Menon. “Every business will need to evolve

HOW INDIA CAN REMAIN THE IT CAPITAL OF THE WORLD

1

The government has to focus on skilling to leverage the country’s demographic dividend

3

The government should invest in research and development to ensure that the industry maintains its lead as the IT capital of the world



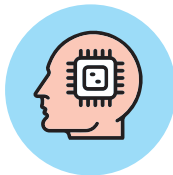
2

Simplification and regulation of various data sets is absolutely necessary for the IT industry to keep innovating

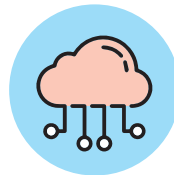
4

Government schemes should be designed keeping in mind the need for innovation in the IT sector

WHERE IS THE INDIAN IT SECTOR INVESTING?



AI/ML



CLOUD



CYBERSECURITY

to become a creator and not just a consumer of talent, and unlock the potential of people by combining the power of technology and human abilities. This is especially true for India, considering our demographic dividend that is crucial for us to realise our aspirations,” she says.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

A vital aspect of India’s tech story is the policy framework and support that is required from the government’s end. When asked about the future of the sector during the

Amrit Kaal and what policy changes the government is mulling to propel its growth in the years leading up to 2047, Ashwini Vaishnaw, Minister of Electronics and Information Technology, told *BT* on the sidelines of the Google for India event in December 2022 that there are a number of legislations—such as the data protection Bill, the telecom Bill and the digital India Bill—that will be tabled in the monsoon session of Parliament. “And in the G20 Summit [in September], we will be showcasing our technological capabilities to the world. Global players